

Mini-Topics

1. Aggro Nodes

Once we take an aggressive, low frequency action (low frequency does not imply aggressive), we arrive to the next street with an extremely filtered & polarised range, in now what I call an 'Aggressive Node' or "Aggro Node". Typically, we can afford to bluff just about anything.

OOP

As OOP has positional disadvantage, we are always incentivised to fast play a little more, relatively speaking, thereby slightly taking away the integrity of the "Aggro Node". We will still arrive as such, just less so. Therefore, we tend to give up our weakest bluffs (unless the respective turn/river is good for us!) in order to bet our stronger bluffs. As we haven't the luxury of checking back to realise our equity for free, realisation of fold equity increases.

IP

This is exacerbated when IP, as having the positional advantage on the previous street makes the choice to polarise even stronger (as opposed to 'smooth-calling'/checking back. => Therefore, we will typically be able to bluff the crappiest of crap, counterintuitively affording us the ability to check back our strongest bluffs that retain the most equity. As bluffs are inherently protected by value, we are in effect using our weakest bluffs as bets, whilst protecting our XB range with our strongest bluffs (still high EQ hands (PIO is binary)), and our middling value.

1. A pattern of aggro nodes is not being indifferent with any strong value, bar the nuts (high visibility)

OOP we may check to protect checking range but IP we basically never x back our strong value in these nodes (with the exception of a hand like JT on JJT2)



BUvsBB
SRP



After big betting flop, BU no longer x-back value

2. Missing aggro nodes will result in massive skews (overfolding) -b10



BUvsB
B SRP



xB125c xx B10 => **BU fold 43.4%**

3. If aggro node is missed and villain doesn't probe into you, you don't get to reopen



If we remove overbets for OOP/IP these effects are amplified considerably

2. Visibility vs Realisation

The higher your visibility, the less equity your hand will relinquish by checking.

Define: **Visibility** is how vulnerable your hand is to be folded away from show down

The higher your realization, the more EV your hand has to capture by betting. Inversely, the lower your realisation, the less EV your hand has to capture by betting.

The better your hand, the more your realization.

Therefore:

Low Visibility with High Realization = BET

High Visibility with Low Realization = CHECK (eg. A-high)

...you'll typically PROTECT your range with high visibility hands

3. Where is the bone going?

Do we want to keep it for ourselves or hand it over to villain? Aka: handing villain equity, in the form of a lure.

$$\text{WITH BONE} - \text{WITHOUT BONE} = X$$

{Count of Allins} * {Equity when Allin} - {Count of Allins} * {Equity when Allin}

If $X > 0$, we prefer to keep the bone for ourselves. Otherwise we prefer to hand them the bone (equity) and luring them in. Naturally, we must hold a strong hand in order to withstand handing over equity

*the bigger the SPR, the less likely you are to hand over the bone!

4. When do you want to have a FD blocker?

(on FD boards, not 3f boards w/ 1 card FD's)

The more polarised villain is, the less you will want to have a FD blocker, as the more of their bluffing range you will block. There is a fine line - an equilibrium. Consider the expense of blocking their bluffs, versus the gain from XYZ.

Another viewpoint: consider HOW MANY bluffs you block. There is a fine line, where blocking too many returns a negative result

TL;DR

How expensive is your blocker vs how expensive is your gain

XYZ:

Blocking bluffs

Vs

More equity hitting 2p

More equity hitting trips

Better bluff catcher on bricks

Better bluff catcher on flush completing rivers (FCRs)

Better bluff raiser on FCRs

Deny equity vs FD's (less outs)

Example:



Facing this action, rank these hands in order of preference:



5. Multiway Focus Points

As humans (recs, weak regs and even strong regs for the most part) are inherently passive & “nutpeddley” (aka weaktight) in these nodes, we can manipulate this to benefit us by picking our spots wisely and then going for “maximal attack”. Moreover, once we figure out which spots to go for (a product of blockers & our villain’s passivity), we can essentially just force them out of the pot. *this is what we would expect from a solver. However, we should intend to be more liberal regarding sizing and frequency, **NOT** hand selection.

- Passive is too passive
- Nutted is too nutted
- Depolarized is too depolarized
- Polarized is too polarized

6. Categories

Say you are facing a bet and you think your hand is either a 0 EV bluff catcher or winning money, ALWAYS call. If it’s either a 0 EV bluff catcher or losing money, always fold. Only randomize if you have 0 indication on which way to go!

6. Categories:

- | | | |
|-----------------------------------|---|------------------|
| • Calling (+EV), or mixing (0EV) | - | (Over)call |
| • Folding (-EV), or mixing (0EV) | - | (Over)fold |
| • Betting (+EV), or mixing (0EV) | - | (Over)bet |
| • Checking (-EV), or mixing (0EV) | - | (Over)check |
| • Raising (-EV), or mixing (0EV) | - | (Over)raise |
| | | |
| • Mix (0EV) | - | Mix |
| | | |
| • Unsure, but close | - | 100% <u>cont</u> |

***make the top of your folding range the bottom of your continue range

7. Bluffing Equity Funnels & Positional Effects

Skipped over this one.

Equity Funnels:

Funnel 1: Fold equity

Funnel 2: Realising your outs

I

The Positional Effects:

IP:

- Realising Equity is free. Therefore, stronger bluffs (with more outs) realise a ton of equity for FREE. This deincentivises bluffing (fold equity).

OOP:

- OOP does not have the luxury to realise equity for free. This incentivises bluffing (fold equity)

TL;DR:

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When IP, you have the opportunity to realise your outs for free. OOP does not have this luxury.

Scenario 1 - IP with a combo draw:

Fold equity is deincentivised, due to the amount of outs you can realise, and for free.

Scenario 2 - OOP with a single overcard draw:

Fold equity is incentivised, due to the lack of outs you have to realise via XX. However, pay mind to your affordability line.

Consider:

- Your eligibility line
- Implied equity
- Blockers
 - Betting: Blocking continues, unblocking folds
 - Checking: Blocking bets, unblocking check backs

8. Global Strategy

Consider: Range Size -> Range Frequency-> Hand Size-> Hand Frequency

- You cannot know your frequency without first knowing your size
- It is viable to use multiple “range sizes” later in the game tree and or in small SRP’s, most specifically OTR

Depolarised

- Consider global as a guideline to do x% more/less than. It is unlikely to find pure hand checks in depolar strategies

Polarised

- Consider global as a metric to do multiple times more/less. In hyperpolarised nodes, it is unlikely to bet any hand at less than global, unless 0%.

In essence: the more polarised you are, the less and less hands you will use, more and more often! Therefore, in hyperpolarised nodes, it is not uncommon to utilise only a few hands, multiple times the global!

TL;DR

Depolarised: How Close to Global?

Polarised: How many times Global?

9. Bet/Raise folding equity myth

EV's are separated by decision – the slate is wiped clean. Therefore, we should not concern ourselves away from doing X because of something potentially happening later in the game tree. Provided we're betting/raising under the correct 'leveraging' scheme and above the 'eligibility line', the single and only metric to consider is blockers!

(showcase bet-calls and bet-folds)

This applies to preflop and postflop, betting and raising

Therefore:

- Do not shy away from stabbing turn because you don't want to "get raised off your equity"
- Do not shy away from 3betting/4betting preflop because you don't want to "get raised off your equity"
- Do not shy away from raising turn because you don't want to "get raised off your equity"

Example:



Which of the following hands should we bet/check? (*Highlight table to see answers*)

K♠Q♠

Q♠T♠

8♠7♠

K♠Q♦

Q♦T♦

T♠8♠

A♠4♠

A♦4♦

K♠6♠

A♠Q♠

A♠T♠

10. Overfolding in Theory

1-A:

Bluff Efficiency: $\text{Bet}/(\text{Pot}+\text{Bet})$

Pod Odds: $\text{Bet}/(\text{Pot}+\text{Bet}*2)$

Note:

- Range definement

When uncapped:

- Game theory revolves around 1-Alpha. However, only when the defender has not capped themselves. Theoretically, “Capping” can only happen via a check, and not always; it is situationally dependent, relative to how polarised the bet would have been. If the defender has called/bet as their last action, they will never overfold, only unless a specific Nut Low card presents itself. These cards will never be flush completers, or bricks; they may only be SD completers, TP completers (overcards) or trip completers (low board pairs).

When Capped:

- If the defender has capped themselves, 1-Alpha will no longer take place. In these nodes strategy can become quite extreme, even including 90% folding responses vs bets less than 1/2p. Seems crazy?

Therefore, it is imperative you know when to incorporate 1-Alpha and when not to. Aka, when you can overfold and when you are not allowed to.

TL;DR

- Their influence in the pot before checking will have a direct correlation with their erraticness in defence
- Uncapped never overfolds
 - “Uncapped” = last decision was a bet/call
- Capped MAY overfold
 - “Capped” = last decision was a check that was mixed – not a pure check
- Never overcall (OTR)
- Slight overfolds happen on ‘nut-low’ rivers

11. Bluffing Types

- Generic:
 - Combo draw
 - Flush draw
 - OESD
 - Gutter
 - TP Draw
- Other:
 - 2nd pair
 - 1 over, 1 under
 - 3rd pair
 - 1 over, 1 under
 - zero equity unblocker mine
 - 2p+trip mine
 - boat mine
 - set mine

Examples:

- 2nd pair draw
 - 1 over, 1 under
 Compare these two spots

A)  BU vs BB srp     xB125C x

B)  BU vs BB srp     xB125C x

In which spot do we bet more with a hand like   ?

- Zero equity unblocker mine

Example:

 BU vs BB srp     xB33C x

On the turn, we play B125 or check, from where and how do we draw our bluffs?

- 2p+trip mine
Compare these two spots

A)  BU vs BB srp     xB33C x  

B)  BU vs BB srp     xB33C x  

In which spot do we prefer to bet more?

- Boat mine
 - Revisit 1:31 on coaching

12. Hypersymmetrical AI tactics

Brick texture

- Size up and bet often

Connected texture

- Size down and check more often. Begin to polarise

Very connected texture (eg. 3f+3s)

- Size down even further and check even more often. Become very polarised.

Ultra connected texture (4s+3f / 4f / 4s+4f):

- Size up down ever further and check even more often. Become ULTRA polarised.

...OR...Check even MORE often! This results in the remaining value range becoming very strong, and thus you actually want to reverse the script and size back up!

13. Situation filtering hierarchy

Measure:

- board texture
- positions (EPvsLP)
- positions (IPvsOOP)
- pot odds

The harder it is to hit the board, the more unpaired (Ax/Kx/Qx/Jx, etc.) hands shoot up in value. Therefore, consider the below sliding scale:

Dry ;;; Disconnected ;;; Innocuous > Dangerous ;;; Connected ;;; Scary:

- unstraighted > straighted > 4s gutter > 4s OE
- 4r > x1fd > x2fd > flushed > 4f
- double paired > triple > paired > unpaired
- R > S > M
- big gap > small gap
- No draws > draws (K72r>K92r)

-
- HU > MW (3) > MW (4)
 - HU > Ring LP > Ring EP

-
- IP > OOP

-
- Vs Small Size > Vs Big Size

Situation filter effects

wide range
disc board
small size

= very wide gameplay = quite unintuitive to guys who haven't done
extensive study

tight range
connected board
big size

= very tight gameplay = quite intuitive

14. C-Betting Turn IP SRP on Straight Completers

When to B70, B100 or B133? Consider the below (70>133)

Consider the below sliding scale (bad>good):

Was the straight draw flopped or turned?	Turned>Flopped
How many straights are there?	3>2>1
Does villain have offsuit combo defence?	Yes>No
What is the suit texture?	x2fd>x1fd>4r

15. BDSDs

It's very important to get good at this!

<https://griddier.com/tools/flop-straight-counter-game>